

Important notes about AKS support policy

Key takeaways

AKS manages and is responsible for:

- The control plane and its components
 - Kubelet
 - DNS services (like CoreDNS)
- Kubernetes proxy or networking (except when BYOCNI is used)
- System components that got automatically added during cluster creation or after enabling an add-on

The customer manages:

- Kubernetes objects he/she deploys
- The application he/she deploys in the AKS cluster like:
 - 3rd party open-source projects
 - 3rd party closed-source software
- Networking customizations other than the ones listed in the AKS documentation
- Custom or 3rd party CNI plugins used in BYOCNI mode

The customer is responsible for:

- Not modifying the nodes using IaaS APIs
- Not altering node configuration in unsupported ways
- Not altering the AKS managed Kubernetes and Azure components
- Keeping the node OS and runtime components patched and up-to-date
- Not stopping AKS nodes via the IaaS API
- Keeping the Kubernetes version up to date
- Not blocking internal subnet traffic using NSG(s) or firewall(s)

AKS and the customer may need to manage other components and have more responsibilities than the ones mentioned, which are just the main key takeaways from the AKS support policy.